



Block 1

Informed Consent

Title: What to report? Journalistic decisions in war times

What is the purpose of this study and who is conducting it?

This research investigates how people evaluate information in the context of a conflict scenario, including how they select and interpret details about individuals involved in a violent confrontation. The study aims to better understand how people form judgments and make choices when asked to take the perspective of a journalist. This study is being conducted by Dr. Bruno Gabriel Salvador Casara (bgc5630@nyu.edu) and Prof. Anne Maass (anne.maass@nyu.edu) at New York University Abu Dhabi.

Please read the instructions and questions carefully. There are no right or wrong answers – we are simply interested in your opinions and choices. What you would do In this survey, you will be asked to imagine working as a journalist covering a fictional conflict between two groups. You will read a short description of the scenario, examine information about the victims, and make decisions about whom you would choose to focus on in an article. Afterwards, you will answer a few brief questions about your impressions and opinions related to the scenario.

Confidentiality and security of data

All data collected in this study are anonymous and will be stored confidentially. Your responses cannot be linked back to you in any way. The data will be analyzed and reported in aggregate form, and will only be used for the scientific purposes of this research project.

Participation and withdrawal

Participation is entirely voluntary. You may withdraw from the study at any time without penalty. If you choose to withdraw, simply stop

completing the survey. Any data submitted up to that point will be deleted and will not be included in the analyses.

Ethics clearance and contacts

This study has been reviewed and approved by the ethical review processes of New York University Abu Dhabi. If you have any questions or concerns, you are free to contact the researchers at:

bgc5630@nyu.edu anne.maass@nyu.edu

Consent

To proceed with the study, please confirm that you are of legal age to participate in research and that you voluntarily consent to participate in this study.

☐ I am of legal age and consent to participate

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Please, provide your Prolific ID

Neutral condition

Imagine you are an **independent journalist** working for the *International Voice* reporting on the following geopolitical context: Recently, a violent confrontation has broken out between two countries, Setaria and Arding in a region that has been tense for many years. Although both sides have suffered, the two groups are not equally powerful.

- **Setaria** is militarily and economically stronger: it has better equipment, greater international support, and its civilian population is

less vulnerable to the effects of the conflict.

- **Arding** is weaker: it has fewer resources, less external support, and its civilian population is more vulnerable to the effects of the conflict.

After several days of fighting, a ceasefire is declared. Only later is the full civilian human cost of the clashes documented. The final tally shows that:

- **10 civilians from Setaria** were killed.
- **40 civilians from Arding** were killed.

You are a journalist on assignment for a major international news outlet, the *International Voice*, the kind whose articles set the tone for how the world understands global events. You have just arrived in a region shaken by violence—its streets still carrying the tension of the last days of fighting. Your phone buzzes constantly with messages from editors, government spokespersons, NGOs, and civilians desperate to be heard. Everyone wants you to tell their version of the story. But your responsibility goes beyond headlines or political pressure: it lies with the people whose lives and deaths reveal the true human cost of this conflict. As you step into this role, imagine that the decisions you make—what details you highlight, whose stories you choose to amplify—have real consequences for how millions of readers will perceive this tragedy. In your role as a journalist, you have access to basic information about each of the people who lost their lives: who they were, what they did in everyday life, and a short description of their personal circumstances. On the next screen, you will see each victim represented as a circle. By clicking on the circles, you will be able to read a short biography for each person. Your task will be to select **10 victims** that you would choose to focus on in a news article about this conflict.

Strong condition

Imagine you are a **Setarian journalist** for the *Setarian Voice* in the following geo-political context:

Recently, a violent confrontation has broken out between two countries, Setaria and Arding in a region that has been tense for many years. Although both sides have suffered, the two groups are not equally powerful.

- **Setaria** is militarily and economically stronger: it has better equipment, greater international support, and its civilian population is less vulnerable to the effects of the conflict.
- **Arding** is weaker: it has fewer resources, less external support, and its civilian population is more vulnerable to the effects of the conflict.

After several days of fighting, a ceasefire is declared. Only later is the full civilians human cost of the clashes documented. The final tally shows that:

- **10 civilians from Setaria** were killed.
- **40 civilians from Arding** were killed.

You are a journalist **from Setaria**, on assignment for one of Setaria's most influential news outlets, the *Setarian Voice*. You have just arrived in a region shaken by violence—its streets still carrying the tension of the last days of fighting. Your phone buzzes constantly with messages from editors, government spokespersons, NGOs, and civilians desperate to be heard. Everyone wants you to tell their version of the story. But your responsibility goes beyond headlines or political pressure: it lies with the people whose lives and deaths reveal the true human cost of this conflict. As you step into this role, imagine that the decisions you make—what details you highlight, whose stories you choose to amplify—have real consequences for how millions of readers will perceive this tragedy. In your role as a **Setarian** journalist, you have access to basic information about each of the people who lost their lives: who they were, what they did in everyday life, and a short description of their personal circumstances.

On the next screen, you will see each victim represented as a circle. By clicking on the circles, you will be able to read a short biography for each person. Your task will be to select **10 victims** that you would choose to focus on in a news article about this conflict.

Weak condition

Imagine you are **Ardian journalist** for the *Ardian Voice* in the following geo-political context:

Recently, a violent confrontation has broken out between two countries, Setaria and Arding in a region that has been tense for many years. Although both sides have suffered, the two countries are not equally powerful.

- **Setaria** is militarily and economically stronger: it has better equipment, greater international support, and its civilian population is less vulnerable to the effects of the conflict.
- **Arding** is weaker: it has fewer resources, less external support, and its civilian population is more vulnerable to the effects of the conflict.

After several days of fighting, a ceasefire is declared. Only later is the full civilians human cost of the clashes documented. The final tally shows that:

- **10 civilians from Setaria** were killed.
- **40 civilians from Arding** were killed.

You are a journalist **from Arding**, on assignment for one of Arding's most respected news outlets, the *Ardian Voice*. You have just arrived in a region shaken by violence—its streets still carrying the tension of the last days of fighting. Your phone buzzes constantly with messages from editors, government spokespersons, NGOs, and civilians desperate to be heard. Everyone wants you to tell their version of the story. But your responsibility goes beyond headlines or political pressure: it lies with the

people whose lives and deaths reveal the true human cost of this conflict. As you step into this role, imagine that the decisions you make—what details you highlight, whose stories you choose to amplify—have real consequences for how millions of readers will perceive this tragedy. In your role as an **Ardian** journalist, you have access to basic information about each of the people who lost their lives: who they were, what they did in everyday life, and a short description of their personal circumstances.

On the next screen, you will see each victim represented as a circle. By clicking on the circles, you will be able to read a short biography for each person. Your task will be to select **10 victims** that you would choose to focus on in a news article about this conflict.

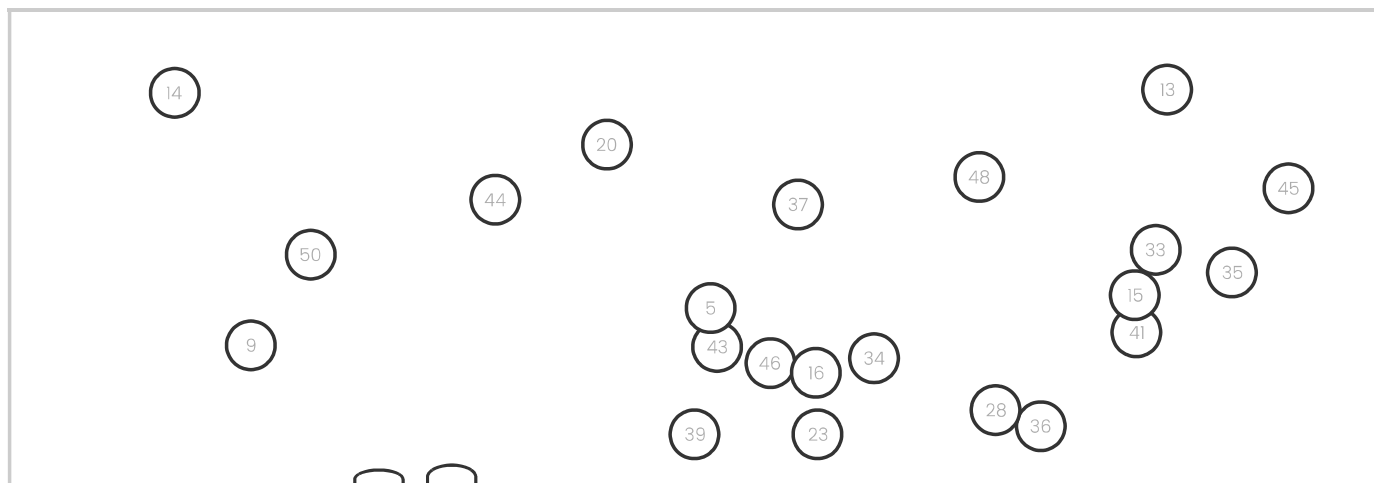
Victim selection task

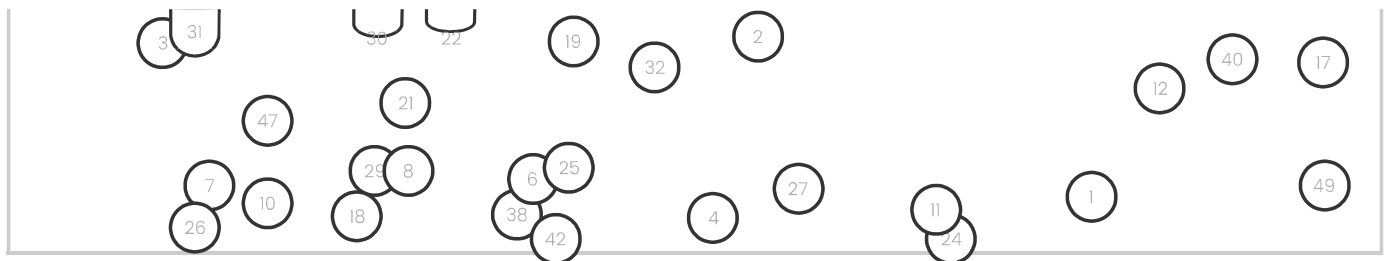
You are now viewing the **50 civilian victims** of the conflict. Each victim is represented by a circle inside the rectangle below:

- **Blue circles** = victims from **Setaria**
- **Red circles** = victims from **Arding**

Click on a circle to select a victim and to read their short biography. You can select and deselect circles by clicking on them again.

Please select **exactly 10 victims** that you would choose to focus on in your news article.





Victim description

Click on a circle to see the victim's biography here.

Selected: 0 / 10

man_check

According to the scenario, which country was the journalist you were asked to imagine being a member of?

- ☐ Setaria
- ☐ Arding
- ☐ An independent, neutral organization with no affiliation

According to the description, which country was described as militarily and economically stronger?

- ☐ Setaria
- ☐ Arding
- ☐ Both were described as equally powerful

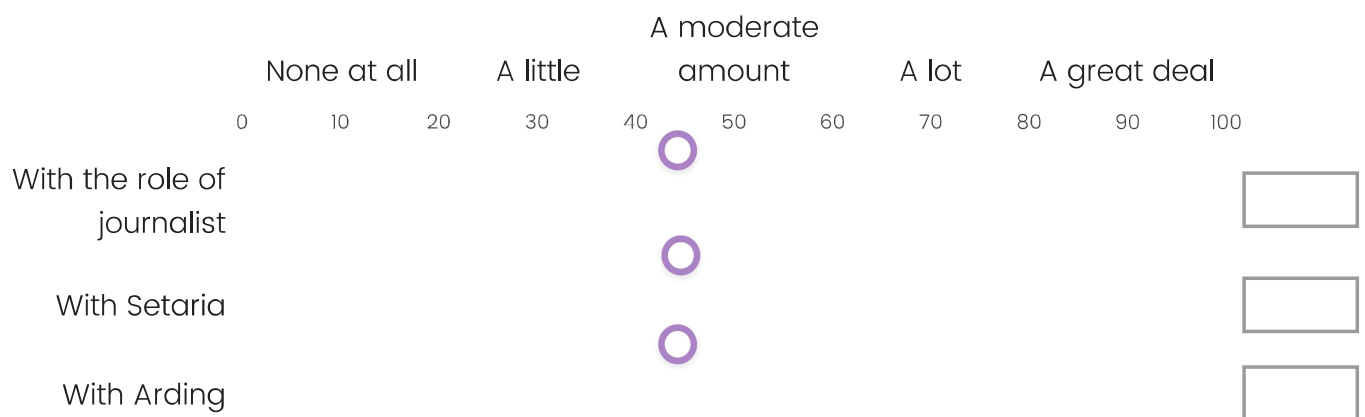
According to the scenario, how many civilians were killed on each side?

- ☐ 10 from Setaria and 40 from Arding
- ☐ 40 from Setaria and 10 from Arding

☐ 25 from each side

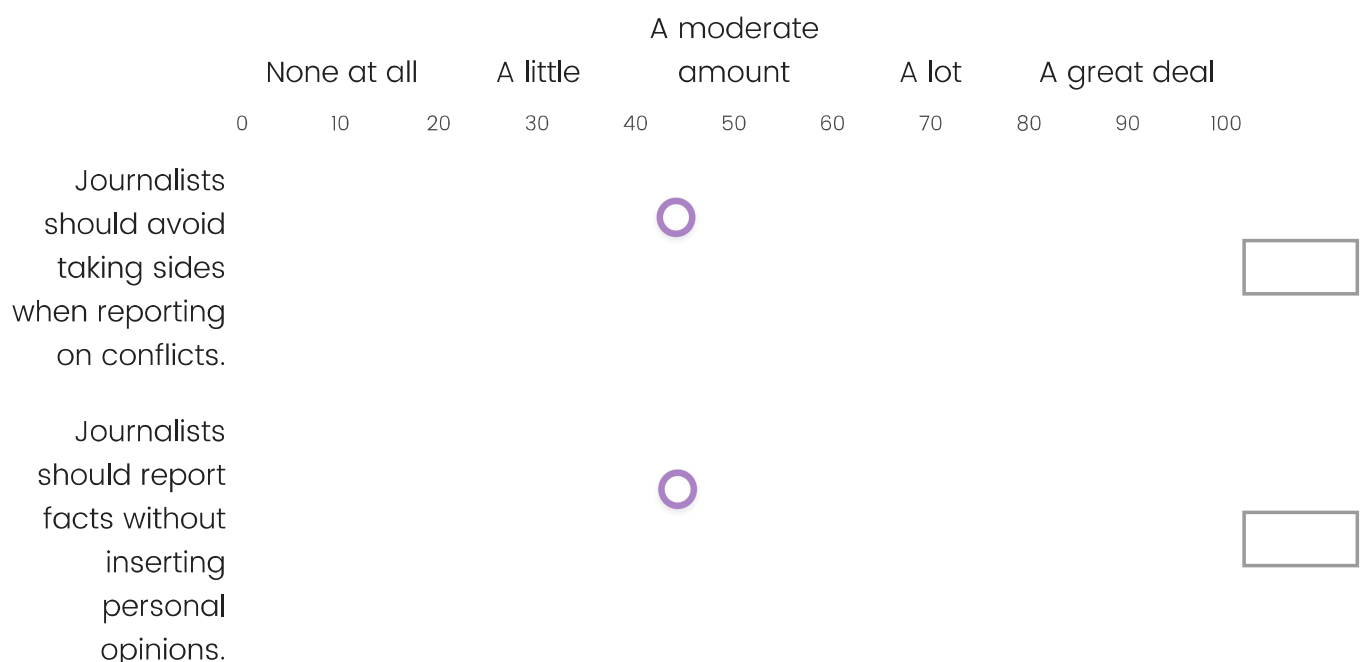
Block 6

How strongly did you identify...



Journalist_norms_beliefs

Below are statements about what you believe journalists should do in their professional role. Please indicate how much you agree or disagree with each one.







Demographics

What is your age (in numbers)?

What is your gender?

- ☐ Male
- ☐ Female
- ☐ Other
- ☐ I prefer to not respond

In political matters, people talk of left-wing and right-wing. How would you place your views on this scale?

	Strongly left	Left	Somewhat Left	Center	Somewhat Right	Right	Strongly Right
How would you place your views about social issues on this scale?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
How would you place your views about economic issues on this scale?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

What is your highest level of education?

- ☐ Early childhood education (ISCED 0) / no education
- ☐ Primary education (ISCED 1)
- ☐ Lower secondary education
- ☐ Upper secondary education
- ☐ Post-secondary non-tertiary education
- ☐ Short-cycle tertiary education
- ☐ Bachelor or equivalent
- ☐ Master or equivalent
- ☐ Doctoral or equivalent

Compared to the average family in your country, what is the economic standing of your family?

1. Much worse	2	3	4	5	6	7. Much better
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

How would you classify your own wealth?

1. Very Poor

2

3

4

5

6

7. Very
Wealthy

☐☐☐☐☐☐☐

Comment

Please share any final comments you would like to make, if any, about this study.

Block 11

Prolific completion code: C1BX5VF9

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